Alternative plan

Diwali Trip to Punjab & Himachal Pradesh

8 – 17 November 2026

Ahmedabad → Amritsar → Dalhousie → Dharamshala → Bir → Kullu → Lahaul → Jispa → Mandi → Chandigarh

Plan as of: 20 October 2026

What's different in this plan

- Skip Chamera Lake and Kangra Fort.
- Day 4: Mata Baglamukhi, HPCA Stadium and Kunal Pathri on the way to Dharamshala.
- Day 6: Norbulingka, Baijnath and Bir, then night in Kullu / Bhuntar.
- Day 7: Atal Tunnel and Sissu, first night in Lahaul.
- Day 8: a full day at Jispa and Darcha (Baralacha La only if the road is open).

Bookings to change

- Valley View Homestay: change to 2 nights, 14–15 Nov (now booked for 15 Nov only).
- Book Kullu / Bhuntar for 13 Nov (no Kangra night).
- Trains, Hotel Himdhara and Hotel Pine View stay as booked.

WHERE WE SLEEP

Sun, 8 Nov	On the train	On the train
Mon, 9 Nov	Amritsar	Booking pending
Tue, 10 Nov	Dalhousie Hotel Himdhara Dalhousie	Confirmed
Wed, 11 Nov	Dharamshala / McLeod Ganj Hotel Pine View	Confirmed
Thu, 12 Nov	Dharamshala / McLeod Ganj Hotel Pine View	Confirmed
Fri, 13 Nov	Kullu / Bhuntar	Booking pending
Sat, 14 Nov	Gondla / Lahaul	Booking pending
Sun, 15 Nov	Gondla / Lahaul	Booking pending
Mon, 16 Nov	Mandi	Booking pending
Tue, 17 Nov	On the train (arrive GNC Wed 18 Nov, 03:05 PM)	On the train

TRAINS

19107 Janmabhoomi Express	Gandhinagar Capital (GNC) Sun 8 Nov · 10:05 AM	Jalandhar City Mon 9 Nov · 10:00 AM	3A · B1 37, 38, 40
19412 DLPC GNC Express	Chandigarh (CDG) Tue 17 Nov · 05:55 PM	Gandhinagar Capital (GNC) Wed 18 Nov · 03:05 PM	3A · B2 27, 29, 30

Booking numbers are partly hidden; check your email or SMS for the full numbers.

Day 1

Sunday, 8 November

The Departure

Ahmedabad → on the train

Wake up: As per your comfort

09:00 AM	Board Janmabhoomi Express from Ahmedabad (boarding station: Gandhinagar Capital (GNC) at 10:05 AM).

19107 · Janmabhoomi Express — Confirmed

Departs	Gandhinagar Capital (GNC) — Sun 8 Nov · 10:05 AM
Arrives	Jalandhar City — Mon 9 Nov · 10:00 AM
Class · Coach · Berths	3A · B1 · 37, 38, 40
PNR	••••••0791

Night stay: On the train

Day 2

Monday, 9 November

The Golden Hour

Jalandhar → Amritsar

Wake up: 07:30 AM (on the train, to get ready for arrival)

10:00 AM	Arrive at Jalandhar City Railway Station. Hire your Tempo Traveller.
10:30 AM – 12:30 PM	Drive from Jalandhar to Amritsar.
12:30 PM	Hotel check-in near the Golden Temple and lunch.
02:00 PM	Depart for the Wagah Border.
04:15 – 05:00 PM	Attari-Wagah Border Ceremony. **Tip:** Winter timings usually start at 4:15 PM, but arrive early to get seats.
07:30 PM	Sri Harmandir Sahib (Golden Temple) at night, then dinner outside.

Hotel near the Golden Temple — Booking pending

Night stay: Amritsar

Day 3

Tuesday, 10 November

Ascent to Dalhousie & The Peak

Amritsar → Dalhousie

Wake up: 05:30 AM (early start for a long drive and a daylight trek)

07:00 AM	Depart Amritsar.
12:30 PM	Arrive in Dalhousie, check into your hotel, and grab a quick lunch.
01:30 PM	Drive to the Dainkund Peak base.
02:00 – 05:00 PM	Dainkund Peak Trek (2 km trek). **Tip:** Start by 2 PM so you are off the trail before the sun sets around 5:30 PM.
06:00 PM	Evening stroll at the Town Center, Mall Road, and colonial viewpoints.

Hotel Himdhara Dalhousie

Confirmed

Address	Church Baloon Road, near Gandhi Chowk, Dalhousie – 176304
Check-in	Tue 10 Nov, after 02:00 PM
Check-out	Wed 11 Nov, before 12:00 PM
Booked via	MakeMyTrip · Booking ID NH••••••••0644

Night stay: Dalhousie

Day 4

Wednesday, 11 November

Baglamukhi & Dharamshala

Dalhousie → Bankhandi → Dharamshala

Wake up: 06:30 AM

08:00 AM	Check out and leave Dalhousie (no Chamera Lake).
08:00 AM – 12:45 PM	Drive via Nurpur and Ranital to Bankhandi (about 4.5 hours).
12:45 – 01:45 PM	Darshan at Mata Baglamukhi Temple, Bankhandi, then lunch. **Tip:** Check afternoon darshan timings — many temples close briefly around midday.
02:00 – 03:30 PM	Drive to Dharamshala (about 1.5 hours).
03:30 PM	HPCA Stadium — photo stop with the Dhauladhar behind.
04:00 PM	Kunal Pathri Temple in the tea gardens.
05:00 PM	Check in at Hotel Pine View.
06:00 PM	Evening on McLeod Ganj Mall Road.

Hotel Pine View

Confirmed

2 nights (Nov 11 – 13) · Night 1

Address	VPO Sudher, Dharamshala – 176215
Check-in	Wed 11 Nov, after 12:00 PM
Check-out	Fri 13 Nov, before 12:00 PM
Booked via	MakeMyTrip · Booking ID NH••••••••9134

Night stay: Dharamshala / McLeod Ganj

Day 5

Thursday, 12 November

Tibetan Heritage & Waterfalls

McLeod Ganj

Wake up: 06:00 AM

07:00 AM	Leave the hotel to enjoy the crisp mountain air.
07:30 AM	Breakfast at a local bakery near the Main Square.
08:45 AM	Dalai Lama Temple & Museum (catch the morning chants).
11:00 AM	Bhagsunag Temple and the hike to Bhagsu Waterfall.
01:15 PM	Lunch at a hillside cafe with a view.
03:15 PM	St. John in the Wilderness Church.
04:30 PM	Naddi View Point. **Tip:** Arrive before the 5:30 PM sunset.
06:30 PM	Free time in Main Square for shopping and exploring.
07:30 PM	Dinner (authentic Tibetan food).

Hotel Pine View Confirmed

Night 2 of 2

Night stay: Dharamshala / McLeod Ganj

Day 6

Friday, 13 November

Norbulingka, Baijnath & Bir

Dharamshala → Palampur → Baijnath → Bir → Kullu

Wake up: 06:30 AM

07:45 AM	Early breakfast, check out of Hotel Pine View.
09:00 – 10:15 AM	Norbulingka Institute, Sidhpur — gardens, workshops, temple. **Tip:** For paragliding at Bir, skip Norbulingka and drive straight to Bir instead.
10:15 – 11:30 AM	Drive via Palampur, short stop at the tea gardens.
11:45 AM	Tashi Jong Monastery, Taragarh (on the main road).
12:15 PM	Shree Shiv Baijnath Temple.
01:00 – 02:00 PM	Lunch in Bir.
02:00 – 02:45 PM	Bir Tibetan Colony, Chokling Monastery and the paragliding landing site.
02:45 – 07:30 PM	Drive via Joginder Nagar and Mandi to Kullu / Bhuntar (about 5 hours). **Tip:** Leave Bir by 2:45 PM so the mountain roads before Mandi are done in daylight.

Hotel in Kullu — Booking pending

Night stay: Kullu / Bhuntar

Day 7

Saturday, 14 November

Through the Tunnel to Lahaul

Kullu → Atal Tunnel → Sissu → Gondla

Wake up: 06:30 AM

07:30 – 10:30 AM	Drive from Kullu to Sissu via the Atal Tunnel.
10:30 AM – 12:30 PM	Sissu: waterfall viewpoint and the Chandra river banks.
12:30 – 01:30 PM	Lunch, then drive on into Lahaul.
02:00 – 03:30 PM	Kardang Monastery, across the river from Keylong, and Keylong market.
04:00 PM	Check in at the homestay and rest — let your body get used to the altitude.

Tip: Fill fuel at Tandi petrol pump — the last fuel station for a long way.

Valley View Homestay Fuktal, Lahaul

Booking pending

Change booking: 2 nights, 14–15 Nov · Night 1

Address	Village Fuktal, Gondla, Lahaul – 175140
Check-in	Sat 14 Nov
Check-out	Mon 16 Nov, before 10:00 AM
Booked via	Goibibo · Booking ID GH••••••••0370

Night stay: Gondla / Lahaul

Day 8

Sunday, 15 November

A Full Day at Jispa

Gondla → Gemur → Jispa → Darcha → Gondla

Wake up: 07:00 AM

08:30 AM	Leave the homestay after breakfast; drive past Keylong towards Jispa.
09:30 AM	Gemur village and monastery, just before Jispa.
10:00 AM – 12:00 PM	Jispa: walk along the Bhaga river, the village and its small monastery; photos of the snow peaks.
12:00 PM	Darcha (7 km): river confluence, Darcha bridge and the police check post. **Tip:** Ask the police about the road ahead. If open: Zingzingbar → Deepak Tal → Baralacha La, turning back by 1 PM. Usually closed by mid-November.
01:00 – 02:30 PM	Packed lunch by the river; slow afternoon around Jispa and Darcha.
03:00 PM	Drive back towards Gondla.
05:00 PM	Back at the homestay before the 5:15 PM sunset; stargazing at night. **Tip:** Icy roads after dark are the main risk — don't stay out late.

Valley View Homestay Fuktal, Lahaul

Booking pending

Night 2 of 2

Address	Village Fuktal, Gondla, Lahaul – 175140
Check-in	Sat 14 Nov
Check-out	Mon 16 Nov, before 10:00 AM
Booked via	Goibibo · Booking ID GH••••••••0370

Night stay: Gondla / Lahaul

Day 9

Monday, 16 November

The Lahaul Morning & Descent to Mandi

Keylong → Atal Tunnel → Mandi

Wake up: 06:30 AM

07:30 – 09:00 AM	Enjoy a crisp, snowy morning in Keylong.
09:00 AM – 03:30 PM	Scenic drive from Keylong back through the Atal Tunnel, bypassing Manali, straight down the river valley to Mandi (approx. 6.5 hours of driving). **Tip:** Leave early to account for mountain traffic.
03:30 PM	Late lunch on arrival in Mandi (or stop along the route).
05:00 PM	Check into your hotel and relax by the Beas River.

Hotel in Mandi, by the Beas River — Booking pending

Night stay: Mandi

Day 10

Tuesday, 17 November

The Journey Home

Mandi → Chandigarh → home

Wake up: 06:30 AM

07:30 AM – 12:30 PM	Drive from Mandi to Chandigarh (approx. 5 hours). **Tip:** Leave early to account for mountain traffic.
12:30 – 03:00 PM	Lunch in Chandigarh. If time permits, a quick walk around Sukhna Lake.
04:00 PM	Arrive at Chandigarh Railway Station.
05:55 PM	Board the train to Gandhinagar from Chandigarh (CDG).

19412 · DLPC GNC Express — Confirmed

Departs	Chandigarh (CDG) — Tue 17 Nov · 05:55 PM
Arrives	Gandhinagar Capital (GNC) — Wed 18 Nov · 03:05 PM
Class · Coach · Berths	3A · B2 · 27, 29, 30
PNR	••••••7012

Night stay: On the train (arrive GNC Wed 18 Nov, 03:05 PM)